The Shadow Theatre

Behind the heavy proscenium curtain lies an intimate theatre of light and shade. Three Venetian oil lamps hang suspended from an iron rail above the stage, casting the sharp profiles of articulated brass puppets across the taut linen screen. Here, the early masters practiced the art of silhouettes to convey silent ciphers.

When the raiders fled through this hall, they left the silhouettes scattered across the boards. To awaken the screen, arrange the brass figures along the beam between the flames. When the shadow of the tower and the crescent align, hold this page against a lantern: the light passing through both faces will bring the secret cipher into focus.

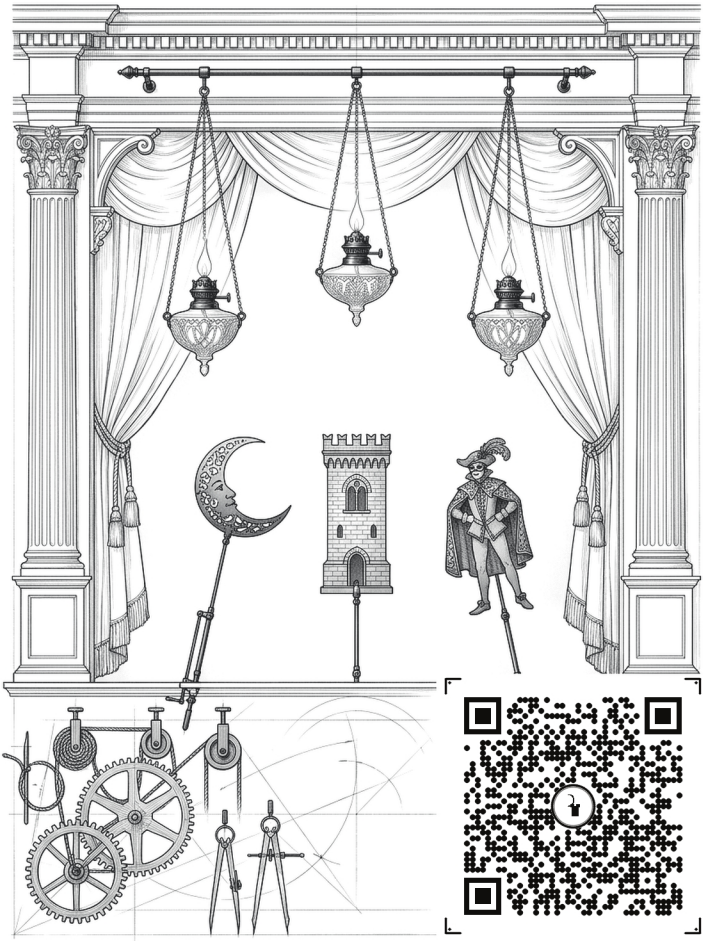


Plate XIV – Apparato per il Teatro delle Ombre (Tower III). Articulated brass silhouettes and room seal.